

About the [National Service Honor Award](#)

The National Service Honor (“NSH” or “National Service Honor Award”) recognizes individuals across the country for their dedication to meaningful volunteer service and their impact on their communities. The National Service Honor was created to continue the legacy of the President’s Volunteer Service Award (“PVSA”) following the retirement of that program and uses the same age-based service-hour thresholds previously used for the PVSA’s Bronze, Silver, and Gold award levels. First Racquet has selected the National Service Honor as our annual service recognition program so that we can continue celebrating the time, commitment, and impact of our volunteers.

To be eligible for an award you must:

- Be at least five years old
- Complete the required number of service hours within the applicable 12-month award period
- Provide sufficient documentation for us to review and verify your service hours

Award Period: For the year of 2026, our 12-month period is **9/16/2025 - 9/15/2026**. Meaning, we will review and verify any service hours completed within 9/16/2025 - 9/15/2026 to go towards an award for 2026.

Award Levels: There are three award levels, as seen in the chart below. Please review all details to determine which level you would like to aim / apply for.

AGE GROUP	HOURS REQUIRED FOR AWARD		
	BRONZE	SILVER	GOLD
KIDS (5 - 10 years old)	26 - 49	50 - 74	75+
YOUTH (11 - 15 years old)	50 - 74	75 - 99	100+
YOUNG ADULTS (16 - 25 years old)	100 - 174	175 - 249	250+
ADULTS (26+)	100 - 249	250 - 499	500+

The age category is determined by the age the person was for at least 7 months within the 12-month calendar year, which aligns with the 12-month period we set as an organization. This means that for our this year’s period, **9/16/2025 - 9/15/2026**, if you turned:

- 11 before February 15th, 2026, you are in the Teens (11-15) age group
- 16 before February 15th, 2026, you are in the Young Adults (16-25) age group
- 26 before February 15th, 2026, you are in the Adults (26+) age group

Application Process

All applications will be reviewed, approved, and confirmed by a Board Member / Advisor. For any questions or concerns, please email admin@firstracquet.org.

Application Deadline: The deadline for submitting your applications for 2026 is by **September 15, 2026 at 11:59 p.m. EST**. We have chosen to align our cycle with the college application cycle to allow for seniors to receive their awards in time for college applications. Although the deadline is in mid-September, we highly encourage you to share your tracking sheet whenever you make any updates so that you always have an accurate count of your qualifying hours. We will send out a reminder email a week before the deadline.

Track Your Volunteer Hours: You must track your volunteer hours individually using this [template](#). Please download a copy of the template to track your hours. Below are some **FAQs** regarding tracking:

1. **What Qualifies as Volunteer Hours?** Any hours that fall under one of the given categories in the tracking spreadsheet qualify as volunteering.
 - a. **External Hours:** the “EXTERNAL HOURS” category is for any community service you engage in external to First Racquet, which will be reviewed on a case by case basis. When selecting “EXTERNAL HOURS” you must provide details to your service and what you learned from it. Additionally, you must provide certification from a supervisor, manager, etc. of your service. This may look like a letter signed by them, an email sent to us (admin@firstracquet.org), etc..
2. **Can I Log Past Hours / Hours Outside of the Award Period?** You may log hours completed up to one calendar year ago, in which we will review and verify those hours for their corresponding award period and honor an award, if applicable. This means that as of our current award year, 2026, **you may submit hours from the period of 9/16/2024 - 9/15/2025 for the 2025 Award Year**. If you submit past hours, please indicate which Award Year you are logging your hours for in the first column of the spreadsheet.
3. **Can I Log Hours I Have Already Received an Award for Before?** No, you may not log hours you have already submitted and received an award for in a previous year and / or with a previous organization.

Submission Process: Please send the following in an email titled “National Service Honor Application - (First and Last Name)” by **11:59 p.m. EST on September 15, 2026**:

1. Your individual tracker linked within the email or attached as a document
2. Your age and birthday
3. Your preferred email address
4. Your desired award level

After Submitting: Once we have reviewed and verified your application, we will send out an email confirming whether or not you have qualified for an award, and which award, if applicable. As soon as available, we will place award orders and update you on when we anticipate their arrival. At a later date, we will hold an award ceremony to celebrate your achievement!